“Śrī Caitanya-caritāmṛta”

Madhya-līlā

Chapter 9

# Śrī Caitanya’s Pilgrimage to the Holy Places

*(translated from the Bengali for this edition)*

**1** The people of the South were like elephants seized by the crocodiles of various doctrines. Gaura freed them with the disc of His mercy and made them Vaiṣṇavas.

**2** Glory, glory to Śrī Caitanya! Glory to Nityānanda! Glory to Advaitacandra! Glory to all the devotees of Gaura!

**3** The Lord’s journey to the south was most extraordinary: He visited thousands upon thousands of holy places.

**4** By touching all those holy places He made them great holy places, and under that pretext He delivered the people of that land.

**5** I cannot set those holy places in order, for His journey to them went right and left, back and forth.

**6** Therefore I simply list their names; I cannot describe them in their proper sequence.

**7–8** As before, whoever saw Him on the road and all the people of every village He came to became Vaiṣṇavas and chanted “Kṛṣṇa” and “Hari.” They in turn delivered other villages, making their people Vaiṣṇavas.

**9** The people of the South were of many kinds: some were jñānīs, some were karmīs, and there were countless pāṣaṇḍīs.

**10** By the power of seeing the Lord, all those people gave up their own doctrines and became Vaiṣṇavas.

**11** Among the Vaiṣṇavas, all were worshipers of Rāma: some were Tattvavādīs, and some were Śrī Vaiṣṇavas.

**12** Upon seeing Mahāprabhu, all those Vaiṣṇavas became worshipers of Kṛṣṇa and took up the name of Kṛṣṇa.

**13** "Rāma! Rāghava! Rāma! Rāghava! Rāma! Rāghava! Save me! Kṛṣṇa! Keśava! Kṛṣṇa! Keśava! Kṛṣṇa! Keśava! Protect me!"

**14** Reciting this verse along the way, the Lord journeyed on. He came to Gautamī-gaṅgā and bathed in the Gaṅgā there.

**15** He went to Mallikārjuna-tīrtha and saw Maheśa (Śiva). There He made all the people take the name of Kṛṣṇa.

**16** He had darśana of Mahādeva, the servant of Rāma, and then went to Ahobala-nṛsiṁha.

**17** Seeing Nṛsiṁha, He offered Him obeisances and prayers. Then He went to Siddhavaṭa, where the Deity of Sītā's Lord is.

**18** Seeing Raghunātha, He offered obeisances and prayers. There a brāhmaṇa invited the Lord to take His meal.

**19** That brāhmaṇa chanted the name of Rāma constantly. Apart from "Rāma, Rāma," he spoke no other word.

**20** Gaurahari stayed in his house that day and accepted His meal there. Then, after blessing him, He went on.

**21** At Skanda-kṣetra He had darśana of Skanda. Then He came to Trimaṭha and saw Trivikrama there.

**22** He came back to Siddhavaṭa, to the house of that brāhmaṇa, and now the brāhmaṇa was constantly chanting the name of Kṛṣṇa.

**23** After taking His meal, Mahāprabhu asked him, “Tell Me, brāhmaṇa, what state has come over you?

**24** Before, you chanted the name of Rāma constantly. Why do you now constantly chant the name of Kṛṣṇa?”

**25** The brāhmaṇa said, “This is by the power of seeing You. When I saw You, the nature I had from birth left me.

**26** From childhood I have chanted the name of Rāma. When I saw You, the name of Kṛṣṇa came to me once.

**27** From that time the name of Kṛṣṇa has sat on my tongue. The name of Kṛṣṇa now manifests there, and the name of Rāma has gone far away.

**28** From childhood I have had one habit: I collect what the scriptures say about the glory of the holy name.

**29** “The yogīs take delight in the Infinite, in true bliss, in the spiritual Self. Therefore this Supreme Brahman is called by the word ‘Rāma.’ ” (Padma Purāṇa, Śata-nāma-stotra)

**30** “The sound ‘kṛṣ’ denotes being, and ‘ṇa’ denotes bliss. Their union, the Supreme Brahman, is called ‘Kṛṣṇa.’ ” (Mahābhārata, Udyoga-parva, 71.4)

**31** Both names belong to the Supreme Brahman and so are equal. But in the scriptures I found a further distinction.

**32** “O fair-faced one, chanting ‘Rāma, Rāma, Rāma,’ I take delight in the enchanting Rāma. The name of Rāma is equal to the thousand names (of Viṣṇu).” (Padma Purāṇa, Bṛhad-viṣṇu-sahasra-nāma-stotra, 72.335)

**33** “The result obtained by reciting the thousand holy names (of Viṣṇu) three times is given by a single utterance of one name of Kṛṣṇa.” (Brahmāṇḍa Purāṇa)

**34** This statement shows the boundless glory of the name of Kṛṣṇa. Still I could not chant it; hear the reason.

**35** Rāma is my chosen Deity, and I find happiness in His name. Finding that happiness, I sang the name of Rāma night and day.

**36** When the name of Kṛṣṇa came to me at the sight of You, its glory took hold of my heart.

**37** I have clearly understood that You are that very Kṛṣṇa.” Saying this, the brāhmaṇa fell at the Lord’s feet.

**38** After showing him mercy, the Lord set out the next day. He came to Vṛddhakāśī and had darśana of Śiva.

**39** Going on from there, He came to a village where there was a community of brāhmaṇas, and He rested there.

**40** Drawn by the Lord’s influence, people came to see Him. Hundreds of thousands and millions came; they could not be counted.

**41** Seeing the Lord's beauty and His absorption in love, everyone said "Kṛṣṇa," and the whole land became Vaiṣṇava.

**42** There were logicians and Mīmāṁsakas, all the Māyāvādīs, and followers of Sāṅkhya and Pātañjala (yoga), of the smṛtis, the Purāṇas and the Āgamas.

**43** All of them were fierce in insisting on their own scriptures, but the Lord exposed the faults of every doctrine and broke them to pieces.

**44** Everywhere the Lord established the Vaiṣṇava siddhānta, and no one could refute His conclusions.

**45** Defeated again and again, they entered into the Lord's doctrine. In this way He made the South Vaiṣṇava.

**46** Hearing of His learning, all the pāṣaṇḍīs came. Full of pride, they came bringing their disciples with them.

**47** A Buddhist ācārya, a great scholar in his own nine principles, began to argue them insistently before the Lord.

**48** Although the Buddhists are not to be spoken with, and it is improper even to look at them, the Lord spoke in order to break their pride.

**49** The Buddhist scriptures, with their "nine principles," rest on logic, so the Lord refuted them by logic alone, and they could not uphold them.

**50** The Buddhist ācārya put forward all nine propositions, and the Lord broke them to pieces with firm reasoning and logic.

**51** All the scholar-philosophers were defeated. People laughed, and the Buddhists felt shame and fear.

**52** Knowing the Lord to be a Vaiṣṇava, the Buddhists went home. Then all of them gathered and made an evil plot.

**53** They filled a plate with impure food and brought it before the Lord, calling it “mahā-prasāda.”

**54** Just then a huge bird came, took the plate with the food in its beak and carried it off.

**55** The impure food fell upon the Buddhists, and the plate fell with a clang on the head of the Buddhist ācārya.

**56** The plate fell edgewise and cut his head, and the ācārya fell to the ground unconscious.

**57** All the disciples cried out in lamentation and wept. They came and took shelter at the Lord’s feet:

**58** “You are the Lord Himself. Forgive our offense. Bring our guru back to life — be merciful!”

**59** The Lord said, “All of you say ‘Kṛṣṇa, Kṛṣṇa, Hari!’ Say the name of Kṛṣṇa loudly into your guru’s ear.

**60** Then your guru will regain consciousness.” All the Buddhists together performed the saṅkīrtana of Kṛṣṇa’s name.

**61** All of them said “Kṛṣṇa! Rāma! Hari!” into their guru’s ear. Regaining consciousness, the ācārya said, “Hari! Hari!”

**62** Saying “Kṛṣṇa,” the ācārya humbly prayed to the Lord. Seeing this, all the people were amazed.

**63** Having played in this way, the son of Śacī disappeared, and no one could see Him.

**64** Mahāprabhu went on and came to Tripati and Trimalla. Seeing the four-armed Deity, He went on to Veṅkaṭādri.

**65** Coming to Tripati, He had darśana of Śrī Rāma, and before Raghunātha He offered obeisances and prayers.

**66** Amazing all the people by His influence, the all-merciful Lord came to Pānā-nṛsiṁha.

**67** Absorbed in love, He offered obeisances and prayers to Nṛsiṁha, and the people were astonished at the Lord's influence.

**68** Coming to Śiva-kāñcī, He had darśana of Śiva, and by His influence He made all the Śaivas Vaiṣṇavas.

**69** Coming to Viṣṇu-kāñcī, He saw Lakṣmī-Nārāyaṇa, bowed down and offered many prayers.

**70** Absorbed in love, He danced and sang a great deal. He stayed there two days and made the people devotees of Kṛṣṇa.

**71** After seeing Trimalaya, He went to Trikālahastī. There He saw Mahādeva and bowed down to him.

**72** At Pakṣī-tīrtha He had darśana of Śiva, and then He went to Vṛddhakola-tīrtha.

**73** There He saw Śveta-varāha and bowed down to Him. Then Gaurahari went to the place of Śiva Pītāmbara.

**74** After seeing the goddess Śiyālī-bhairavī, the son of Śacī came to the bank of the Kāverī.

**75** At Go-samāja He saw Śiva, and then He came to Vedāvana. There He saw Mahādeva and paid him homage.

**76** Seeing Śiva Amṛta-liṅga, He paid him homage. In all the temples of Śiva, the Śaivas became Vaiṣṇavas.

**77** Coming to Devasthāna, He had darśana of Viṣṇu, and there He was constantly in discussion with the Śrī Vaiṣṇavas.

**78** At Kumbhakarṇa-kapāla the beautiful Gaurāṅga saw the lake, and at Śiva-kṣetra He saw Śiva.

**79** At Pāpanāśana He had darśana of Viṣṇu, and then He went to Śrī Raṅga-kṣetra.

**80** He bathed in the Kāverī and saw Raṅganātha. Offering prayers and obeisances, He felt His purpose fulfilled.

**81** Absorbed in love, He sang and danced a great deal, and all the people who saw it were amazed.

**82** A Śrī Vaiṣṇava named Veṅkaṭa Bhaṭṭa respectfully invited the Lord.

**83** He brought the Lord to his house and washed His feet, and he and his whole family drank that water.

**84** After serving Him a meal, he made a request: “O Lord, Cāturmāsya has come and is at hand.

**85** Be merciful and stay in my house for Cāturmāsya. Speak about Kṛṣṇa and mercifully deliver me.”

**86** The Lord stayed in his house, relishing talks about Kṛṣṇa, and happily spent the four months with the Bhaṭṭa.

**87** Every day He bathed in the Kāverī, had darśana of Śrī Raṅga and danced, absorbed in love.

**88** Everyone who saw His beauty and the rest and His absorption in love came to see Him; they saw Him, and their sorrow and grief were destroyed.

**89** Hundreds of thousands of people came from various lands, and on seeing the Lord all of them chanted the name of Kṛṣṇa.

**90** No one spoke anything but the name of Kṛṣṇa. Everyone became a devotee of Kṛṣṇa, and the people were amazed.

**91** All the Vaiṣṇava brāhmaṇas living in Śrī Raṅga-kṣetra invited Him, each for one day.

**92** One day each, and the Cāturmāsya came to an end; some brāhmaṇas never got the chance to serve Him a meal.

**93** In that holy place lived a Vaiṣṇava brāhmaṇa who would come to the temple and recite the Gītā.

**94** Overwhelmed with bliss, he read all eighteen chapters; he read them incorrectly, and people mocked him.

**95** Some laughed and some censured him, but he paid no heed. Absorbed, he read the Gītā with a joyful heart.

**96** As long as he read, his hair stood on end, and he shed tears, trembled and perspired. Seeing this, Mahāprabhu was delighted.

**97** Mahāprabhu asked him, “Listen, good sir: what meaning do you understand that gives you such happiness?”

**98** The brāhmaṇa said, “I am a fool and do not know the meaning of the words. Correctly or incorrectly, I read the Gītā in obedience to my guru’s order.

**99** On Arjuna’s chariot Kṛṣṇa holds the reins. He is seated there, a dark and beautiful form.

**100** He spoke beneficial instructions to Arjuna. Seeing Him, I am overwhelmed with bliss.

**101** As long as I read, I see Him. That is why my mind will not give up reading the Gītā.”

**102** The Lord said, “You alone are truly qualified to read the Gītā; you know the essence of its meaning.”

**103** Saying this, the Lord embraced the brāhmaṇa, and the brāhmaṇa clasped the Lord’s feet and wept.

**104** “Seeing You, my happiness is twice as great. I feel that You are that very Kṛṣṇa.”

**105** His mind had become pure through Kṛṣṇa’s manifestation in his heart; therefore he understood the whole truth about the Lord.

**106** Then Mahāprabhu instructed him: “Do not reveal this matter to anyone.”

**107** That brāhmaṇa became a great devotee of Mahāprabhu, and for four months he never left the Lord's company.

**108** In this way Gauracandra lived in the Bhaṭṭa's house, constantly enjoying the bliss of talks about Kṛṣṇa with him.

**109** Being a Śrī Vaiṣṇava, the Bhaṭṭa served Lakṣmī-Nārāyaṇa. Seeing his devotion, the Lord was pleased at heart.

**110** Being constantly together, they came to feel like friends, and, as friends do, the two joked and teased each other.

**111** The Lord said, "Bhaṭṭa, your goddess Lakṣmī dwells on the chest of her husband; she is the crown jewel of chaste women.

**112** But My Lord Kṛṣṇa is a cowherd who tends cows. Why should a chaste lady desire His company?

**113** For this she gave up the enjoyment of happiness and for a long time kept vows and rules and performed boundless austerities.

**114** "O Lord, we do not know by what merit this one has gained the right to touch the dust of Your feet. Desiring it, Śrī, the best of women, gave up all desires, kept vows and performed austerities for a very long time." (Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam, 10.16.36)

**115** The Bhaṭṭa said, "Kṛṣṇa and Nārāyaṇa are one and the same form, but in Kṛṣṇa there is more playfulness, more artfulness in His pastimes, and so on.

**116** His touch does not violate her chastity. Lakṣmī desires Kṛṣṇa's company out of playful curiosity.

**117** “By siddhānta there is no difference between the forms of the Lord of Śrī and of Kṛṣṇa. Yet in rasa the form of Kṛṣṇa excels: such is the nature of rasa.” (Bhakti-rasāmṛta-sindhu, 1.2.59)

**118** In Kṛṣṇa’s company the duty of chastity is not destroyed; rather she gains more — the enjoyment of the rāsa dance.

**119** If the playful Lakṣmī longs for Kṛṣṇa, what fault is there in that? Why do You laugh at it?”

**120** The Lord said, “I know there is no fault in it. But I hear from the scriptures that Lakṣmī did not attain the rāsa dance.

**121** “At the festival of the rāsa dance He embraced the beautiful women of Vraja around their necks with His arms, and they attained their heart’s desire. Such favor was not granted even to Śrī, who is wholly devoted to Him, nor to the celestial women, fragrant and radiant like lotuses — what then of others?” (Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam, 10.47.60)

**122** Why did Lakṣmī not attain it? What is the reason? And how did the Śrutis attain Kṛṣṇa by performing austerities?

**123** “That which the sages worship in the heart, having restrained breath, mind and senses in firm yoga, Your enemies attained simply by remembering You. The women whose minds were fixed on Your arms, like the coils of the king of serpents, attained the nectar of Your lotus feet; and we, the Śrutis, are equal to them, for You see all equally.” (Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam, 10.87.23)

**124** The Śrutis attained it, but Lakṣmī did not — what is the reason?” The Bhaṭṭa said, “My mind cannot enter into this.

**125** I am a jīva of small intelligence, unsteady by nature, while the Lord's pastimes are as deep as ten million oceans.

**126** You are that very Kṛṣṇa, and You know Your own deeds. Only one to whom You reveal it knows the secret of Your pastimes."

**127** The Lord said, "Kṛṣṇa has one living characteristic, ever active: by His own sweetness He attracts every heart.

**128** His feet are attained by following the feelings of the people of Vraja, and the people of Vraja do not know Him as the Lord.

**129** One, regarding Him as her son, ties Him to a mortar; another, regarding Him as a friend, defeats Him and climbs onto His shoulders.

**130** The people of Vraja know Him as the son of the king of Vraja; they acknowledge no relationship with Him based on awareness of His majesty.

**131** Whoever worships in the mood of the people of Vraja attains in Vraja the son of the king of Vraja in His pure form.

**132** "This Bhagavān, the son of the gopī, is not so easily attained by the embodied, nor by jñānīs who have realized the self, as He is by those who have devotion." (Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam, 10.9.21)

**133** The Śrutis became followers of the gopīs and worshiped the son of the queen of Vraja, taking on the mood of the gopīs.

**134** When in Vraja they obtained the bodies of gopīs, outwardly and inwardly, in those bodies they enjoyed the rāsa dance with Kṛṣṇa.

**135** Kṛṣṇa belongs to the cowherd folk, and the gopīs are His beloveds. Kṛṣṇa does not accept a goddess or any other woman.

**136** Lakṣmī desires Kṛṣṇa's company in that same body of hers; she did not worship Him as a follower of the gopīs.

**137** In any other body one does not attain the rāsa play. That is why Vedavyāsa spoke the verse beginning "nāyaṁ."

**138** Before this, there was a proud conviction in the Bhaṭṭa's mind that Śrī Nārāyaṇa is Svayam Bhagavān,

**139** and that worship of Him is of the highest order, so the worship of the Śrī Vaiṣṇavas is the highest of all.

**140** To break this pride of his, the Lord spoke all these words in jest.

**141** The Lord said, "Bhaṭṭa, do not doubt it: it is certain that Kṛṣṇa is Svayam Bhagavān.

**142** Śrī Nārāyaṇa is Kṛṣṇa's form for pastimes (vilāsa-mūrti); that is why He captivates the minds of Lakṣmī and others.

**143** "All these (avatāras) are portions (*aṁśa*) and parts of portions (*kalā*) of the Puruṣa, but Kṛṣṇa is Bhagavān Himself. Age after age They bring happiness to the world when it is troubled by the enemies of Indra." (Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam, 1.3.28)

**144** Kṛṣṇa has extraordinary qualities beyond Nārāyaṇa's; that is why Lakṣmī constantly thirsts for Kṛṣṇa.

**145** The verse you recited is itself the proof: that verse shows that Kṛṣṇa is Svayam Bhagavān.

**146** "By siddhānta there is no difference between the forms of the Lord of Śrī and of Kṛṣṇa. Yet in rasa the form of Kṛṣṇa excels: such is the nature of

rasa.” (Bhakti-rasāmṛta-sindhu, 1.2.59)

**147** Kṛṣṇa, Svayam Bhagavān, captivates the mind of Lakṣmī, but Nārāyaṇa cannot captivate the minds of the gopīs.

**148** What to speak of Nārāyaṇa? Śrī Kṛṣṇa Himself becomes Nārāyaṇa to make the gopīs laugh.

**149** He shows a four-armed form before the gopīs, but the gopīs feel no loving attachment for that “Kṛṣṇa.”

**150** “What wise man can fathom the ways of the gopīs’ love for the son of the cowherd king — a love that moves on a path beyond comprehension? For even when He reveals a form of Viṣṇu, wondrous in its splendour, with four victorious arms, their love, alas, shrinks back.” (Lalita-mādhava, 6.14)

**151** Speaking thus, the Lord crushed his pride. Then, to make him happy, He turned the argument around and said:

**152** “Do not be sad, Bhaṭṭa; I was only joking. Now hear the conclusion of the scriptures on which the Vaiṣṇavas’ faith rests.

**153** Just as Kṛṣṇa and Nārāyaṇa are one and the same form, so there is no difference between the gopīs and Lakṣmī: they are one in form.

**154** One and the same form assumes various appearances. Know the truth: there is no difference between the gopīs and Lakṣmī.

**155** Through the gopīs, Lakṣmī tastes the joy of Kṛṣṇa’s company. To see any difference in Their Godhood is an offense.

**156** The Lord is one; according to each devotee’s meditation, one and the same form assumes various appearances.

**157** “As a gem joined with blue, yellow and other colors appears different, so Acyuta takes different forms according to the meditation of the worshiper.” (Śrī Nārada-pañcarātra)

**158** The Bhaṭṭa said, “How far apart we are: I, a fallen jīva, and You, that very Kṛṣṇa, the Lord Himself!

**159** I know nothing of the Lord’s fathomless pastimes. Whatever You say, I accept as the truth.

**160** Lakṣmī-Nārāyaṇa have shown me Their full mercy; by Their mercy I have been granted the sight of Your feet.

**161** In Your mercy You have told me of the greatness of Kṛṣṇa, whose beauty, qualities and majesty no one can measure.

**162** Now I have understood that devotion to Kṛṣṇa is above all. You have fulfilled my life by mercifully telling me this.”

**163** Saying this, the Bhaṭṭa fell at the Lord’s feet, and the Lord mercifully embraced him.

**164** When the Cāturmāsya was over, the Lord took the Bhaṭṭa’s leave, saw Śrī Raṅga and went on to the south.

**165** The Bhaṭṭa went along with Him and would not go home; only with great effort did the Lord send him back.

**166** In separation from the Lord, the Bhaṭṭa fell unconscious. Such are the playful pastimes of Śacī’s son.

**167** Gaurahari went on and came to Ṛṣabha hill. There He saw Nārāyaṇa and offered obeisances and prayers.

**168** Paramānanda Purī was staying there for the four months. Hearing this, Mahāprabhu went to Purī Gosāñi.

**169** The Lord bowed at the feet of Purī Gosāñi, and Purī Gosāñi lovingly embraced Him.

**170** For three days the two of them stayed together in that brāhmaṇa's house, rejoicing in loving talks about Kṛṣṇa.

**171** Purī Gosāñi said, "I shall go to Puruṣottama. After seeing Puruṣottama, I shall go to Gauḍa to bathe in the Gaṅgā."

**172** The Lord said, "Please come back to Nīlācala. I shall return from Setubandha before long.

**173** I wish to stay in your company, so be kind to Me and come to Nīlācala."

**174** Having said this and taken his leave, the Lord went on to the south in great joy.

**175** Paramānanda Purī then set out for Nīlācala, and Mahāprabhu went on and came to Śrī Śaila.

**176** Śiva and Durgā lived there in the guise of a brāhmaṇa couple. Seeing Mahāprabhu, both were overjoyed.

**177** They invited Him and served Him meals for three days, and the two sat in seclusion and spoke of confidential matters.

**178** After holding spiritual discussions with him, Mahāprabhu took his leave and came to Kāmakoṣṭhī-purī.

**179** From Kāmakoṣṭhī He came to Southern Mathurā, and there He met a brāhmaṇa.

**180** That brāhmaṇa invited Mahāprabhu. He was a devotee of Rāma, a renounced great soul.

**181** After bathing in the Kṛtamālā, the Lord came to his house. But what meal could the brāhmaṇa serve? He had not cooked.

**182** Mahāprabhu said to him, “Listen, good sir: it is already midday. Why has nothing been cooked?”

**183** The brāhmaṇa said, “O Lord, I live in the forest, and at present the things needed for cooking are not to be had here.

**184** Lakṣmaṇa will bring wild greens, fruits and roots, and then Sītā will do the cooking.”

**185** The Lord was pleased to hear of his way of worship, and the brāhmaṇa cooked in great haste.

**186** The Lord took His meal in the third watch of the day, but the brāhmaṇa, dejected, went on fasting.

**187** The Lord said, “Brāhmaṇa, why are you fasting? Why such sorrow, why such despair?”

**188** The brāhmaṇa said, “I have no more use for my life. I shall enter fire or water and give it up.

**189** Sītā, our Queen, is Mahā-Lakṣmī, the mother of the world — and a rākṣasa touched her! This I hear with my own ears.

**190** It is not fitting for me to keep this body any longer. My body burns with this grief, yet life does not leave it.”

**191** The Lord said, “Do not think this way any more. You are a paṇḍita — why do you not consider the matter?

**192** Sītā, the beloved of the Lord, is a form of spirit and bliss; material senses have no power even to see her.

**193** Touching her is out of the question — they cannot even see her. What Rāvaṇa carried off was only an illusory likeness of Sītā.

**194** The moment Rāvaṇa came, Sītā disappeared and sent a *māyā-Sītā* before him.

**195** A transcendental reality is never within the range of the material: the Vedas and Purāṇas declare this again and again.

**196** Have faith in My words, and never again let such wrong thoughts enter your mind.”

**197** The brāhmaṇa came to believe the Lord’s words. He ate, and his hope of life returned.

**198** Having comforted him, the Lord went on. After bathing in the Kṛtamālā, He came to Durvaśana.

**199** In Durvaśana He had *darśana* of Raghunātha, and on the Mahendra hill He offered homage to Paraśurāma.

**200** Coming to Setubandha, He bathed at Dhanus-tīrtha; then He saw Rāmeśvara and rested there.

**201** There, in an assembly of brāhmaṇas, He heard the *Kūrma Purāṇa*, and in it came the story of the chaste wife.

**202** The daughter of Janaka, the crown jewel of chaste wives, is Sītā, the mother of the world and the wife of Rāma.

**203** When Sītā saw Rāvaṇa, she took shelter of Agni, and Agni hid Sītā from Rāvaṇa.

**204** He heard in the story that Rāvaṇa had taken a "*māyā-Sītā*," and hearing it, Mahāprabhu rejoiced at heart.

**205** Agni took Sītā and kept her with Pārvatī, and deceived Rāvaṇa by giving him a "*māyā-Sītā*."

**206** When Raghunātha came and slew Rāvaṇa, He had Sītā brought to undergo the ordeal by fire.

**207** Then Agni made the *māyā-Sītā* vanish, brought the real Sītā and gave her back in Rāma's presence.

**208** Hearing these conclusions, the Lord was overjoyed. He asked the brāhmaṇas for that leaf and took it.

**209** He had a new leaf written and put into the book, and, for the sake of credence, asked for the old leaf and took it.

**210** Taking the leaf, He came back to Southern Mathurā and gave it to the brāhmaṇa Rāmadāsa.

**211** "Propitiated by Sītā, Agni produced a shadow Sītā. The ten-headed Rāvaṇa carried her off, while Sītā herself went to the abode of Agni." (Kūrma Purāṇa)

**212** “At the time of the ordeal the shadow Sītā entered the fire, and Agni brought Sītā and delivered her before Rāma.” (Kūrma Purāṇa)

**213** Receiving the leaf, the brāhmaṇa was overjoyed. He clasped the Lord’s feet and wept.

**214** The brāhmaṇa said, “You are Śrī Raghunandana Himself, and You have given me *darśana* in the garb of a sannyāsī.

**215** You have delivered me from great sorrow. Please accept a meal in my house today.

**216** That day, in my grief, I did not give You a proper meal; by my good fortune I have seen You once again.”

**217** Saying this, the brāhmaṇa happily cooked and served the Lord a splendid meal.

**218** Gaurahari stayed there that night, showing him mercy, and then went to the Tāmraparṇī in the Pāṇḍya country.

**219** He bathed in the Tāmraparṇī and, on its bank, saw Naya Tripati, the nine Tripatis, wandering about joyfully.

**220** At the holy place of Ciyaḍatalā He saw Śrī Rāma and Lakṣmaṇa, and coming to Tilakāñcī, He had *darśana* of Śiva.

**221** At Gajendra-mokṣaṇa-tīrtha He saw the Deity of Viṣṇu, and coming to Pānāgaḍi-tīrtha, He saw the Lord of Sītā.

**222** Coming to Cāmtāpura, He saw Śrī Rāma and Lakṣmaṇa; coming to Śrī Vaikuṇṭha, He had *darśana* of Viṣṇu.

**223** On the Malaya hill He offered homage to Agastya, and there He had *darśana* of Kanyākumārī.

**224** Having seen Śrī Rāma at Āmlitalā, Gaurahari came to the Mallāra country, where the Bhaṭṭathāris live.

**225** After seeing Tamāla-kārttika He came to Vetāpani; there He saw Raghunātha and spent the night.

**226** The brāhmaṇa Kṛṣṇadāsa, who was travelling with the Lord, met the Bhaṭṭathāris there.

**227** By showing him women and wealth they aroused his greed and robbed that good and simple brāhmaṇa of his reason.

**228** Rising in the morning, the brāhmaṇa went to the Bhaṭṭathāris' dwelling, and the Lord quickly came there in search of him.

**229** Coming there, He said to all the Bhaṭṭathāris, "Why are you keeping My brāhmaṇa?

**230** See, I am a sannyāsī, and you too are sannyāsīs. Yet you give Me pain — I cannot call this justice on your part."

**231** Hearing this, all the Bhaṭṭathāris rose up with weapons and came running at Him from all sides to kill Him.

**232** Their weapons fell from their hands upon their own bodies. Cut to pieces, the Bhaṭṭathāris fled in all directions.

**233** A great wailing arose in the Bhaṭṭathāris' dwelling, and the Lord seized the brāhmaṇa by the hair and led him away.

**234** That same day He came to the bank of the Payasvinī, bathed, and went to the temple of Ādi-keśava.

**235** Seeing Keśava, He was overwhelmed with love and offered many obeisances and prayers, dancing and singing.

**236** Seeing His love, the people were utterly amazed, and everyone honoured the Lord in the highest way.

**237** There He held discussions with great devotees, and there He found the manuscript of the chapter of the *Brahma-saṁhitā*.

**238** Finding the manuscript, the Lord felt boundless joy, and the transformations of ecstasy appeared in Him — trembling, tears, perspiration, stupor and horripilation.

**239** No scripture of conclusive truth equals the *Brahma-saṁhitā*: it is the supreme source of the knowledge of Govinda's glory.

**240** In few words it sets forth boundless conclusions; among all the Vaiṣṇava scriptures it is the very essence.

**241** With great care He had the manuscript copied and took it with Him, and joyfully came to Ananta-padmanābha.

**242** For two days He had *darśana* of Padmanābha, and then joyfully came to see Śrī Janārdana.

**243** For two days He sang and danced there in *kīrtana*; then, coming to the Payasvinī, He saw Śaṅkara-nārāyaṇa.

**244** He came to the Śṛṅgeri Maṭha, the seat of Śaṅkarācārya; then He saw Matsya-tīrtha and bathed in the Tuṅgabhadrā.

**245** He came to the seat of Madhvācārya, where the Tattvavādīs live, and seeing “Kṛṣṇa” in Uḍupī, He became mad with love.

**246** He saw the supremely enchanting “Nartaka-gopāla,” the dancing Gopāla, who had come to Madhvācārya after appearing to him in a dream.

**247** He had lain beneath a load of *gopī-candana* in a boat, and somehow He came to Madhvācārya.

**248** Madhvācārya brought Him and installed Him, and to this day the Tattvavādīs serve Him.

**249** Seeing the Deity of Kṛṣṇa, the Lord felt great happiness, and in ecstatic love He danced and sang at length.

**250** The Tattvavādīs took the Lord for a “Māyāvādī,” and at their first meeting they did not speak to Him.

**251** Later, seeing His ecstatic love, they were amazed, and regarding Him as a Vaiṣṇava, they honoured Him greatly.

**252** Knowing that in their hearts they all took pride in their “Vaiṣṇavism,” Gauramaṇi, the jewel Gaura, smiled slightly and spoke.

**253** Knowing the pride in their hearts, Gauracandra began a discussion with them all.

**254** The ācārya of the Tattvavādīs was learned in all the scriptures, and the Lord, as if He were humble, put a question to him:

**255** “I do not properly understand the goal (*sādhya*) and the means (*sādhana*). Please tell Me which goal and which means are the highest.”

**256** The ācārya said, “To follow the duties of *varṇa* and *āśrama* and offer them to Kṛṣṇa — this is the best ‘means’ for a devotee of Kṛṣṇa.

**257** To attain the five kinds of liberation and go to Vaikuṇṭha is the highest ‘goal’ — so the scriptures determine.”

**258** The Lord said, “The scriptures declare that hearing and chanting are the ‘supreme means’ to the fruit of loving service to Kṛṣṇa.

**259–260** “Hearing about Viṣṇu and chanting His glories, remembering Him, serving His feet, worshipping Him, offering Him prayers, serving Him as His servant, befriending Him and offering Him one’s whole self — if a person offers devotion to Viṣṇu with these nine marks and performs it directly for the Lord, I consider that the highest learning.” (Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam 7.5.23–24)

**261** From hearing and chanting arises love (*premā*) for Kṛṣṇa. That is the fifth goal of life, the furthest limit of all human goals.

**262** “One who has taken this vow, chanting the names of his beloved Lord, finds love awakening within him; his heart melts, and, heedless of the world, he laughs aloud, weeps, cries out, sings and dances like a madman.” (Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam, 11.2.40)

**263** All the scriptures censure *karma* and enjoin its renunciation: loving devotion (*prema-bhakti*) to Kṛṣṇa never arises from *karma*.

**264** “One who knows the merits and faults of his duties, though I Myself have enjoined them, gives them all up and worships Me — he is the best of the saintly.” (Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam 11.11.32)

**265** “Give up all duties and take shelter in Me alone. I shall deliver you from all sins; do not grieve.” (Bhagavad-gītā 18.66)

**266** “One should go on performing one’s prescribed duties only so long as one has not grown weary of them, or so long as faith has not been born in hearing about Me and the like.” (Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam 11.20.9)

**267** The devotees reject the five kinds of liberation; they deem “liberation” worthless and look upon it as no better than hell.

**268** “My devotees accept nothing but service to Me — not even when they are offered residence in My world, opulence equal to Mine, nearness to Me, a form like Mine, or even oneness with Me.” (Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam, 3.29.13)

**269** “The king did not desire land, sons, kinsmen, wealth and wife, so hard to give up, nor even Śrī, the goddess of fortune, whose kind glance the best of the gods long for. This is fitting for great souls whose minds are devoted to the service of Kṛṣṇa, the foe of Madhu: for them even liberation is worthless.” (Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam 5.14.44)

**270** “Those who are devoted to Nārāyaṇa fear nothing from any quarter; in heaven, in liberation and even in hell they see the same worth.” (Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam 6.17.28)

**271** Liberation and *karma* — these two things the devotees give up, yet you establish those very two as the ‘goal’ and the ‘means.’

**272** Seeing that I am a sannyāsī, you are deceiving Me, and so you have not told Me the true nature of the goal and the means.”

**273** Hearing this, the ācārya of the Tattvavādīs was ashamed at heart, and seeing the Lord’s Vaiṣṇava spirit, he was astonished.

**274** The ācārya said, “What You say is true; in all the scriptures this is the firm conclusion of the Vaiṣṇavas.

**275** Yet Madhvācārya laid down this rule, and because of our connection with his *sampradāya* we all follow it.”

**276** The Lord said, “The *karmī* and the *jñānī* are both devoid of devotion, and in your *sampradāya* I see the signs of both.

**277** Only one merit do I see in your *sampradāya*: you firmly hold that the Lord’s form is real (*satya-vigraha*).”

**278** Having thus crushed their pride in their own home, Śrī Gaurahari then came to Phalgu-tīrtha.

**279** At Tritakūpa He had *darśana* of Viśālākṣī, and then the son of Śacī came to Pañcāpsarā-tīrtha.

**280** After seeing Śiva in Gokarṇa He came to Dvaipāyani, and then the crown jewel of sannyāsīs came to the holy place of Sūrpāraka.

**281** In Kolāpura He saw Lakṣmī and then Kṣīra-bhagavatī; He saw Lāṅga-gaṇeśa and then Cora-pārvatī.

**282** From there Gauracandra came to Pāṇḍarapura, and seeing Viṭhṭhala Ṭhākura, He was filled with bliss.

**283** In ecstatic love He sang and danced at length in *kīrtana*, and a brāhmaṇa there invited Him.

**284** With great affection the brāhmaṇa served the Lord a meal, and after the meal the Lord received some good news there.

**285** A disciple of Mādhava Purī (Mādhavendra Purī) named Śrī Raṅga Purī was staying in a brāhmaṇa’s house in that village.

**286** Hearing this, the Lord set out to see him, and He found him sitting in the brāhmaṇa's house.

**287** In ecstatic love He offered him prostrate obeisances; tears, horripilation and trembling came over Him, and sweat streamed from all His limbs.

**288** Seeing this, Śrī Raṅga Purī was amazed at heart, and he said, "Rise, Śrīpāda!

**289** Śrīpāda, You must have a connection with my Gosāñi, Mādhavendra Purī; without it there is not even a trace of such love anywhere."

**290** Saying this, he raised the Lord and embraced Him, and clasping each other around the neck, they both wept.

**291** After a while they came out of their ecstasy and grew calm, and the Lord told him of His connection with Īśvara Purī.

**292** A wondrous flood of love welled up in them both. Showing each other respect, they sat down together in bliss.

**293** Night and day the two of them spoke about Kṛṣṇa, and in this way they spent five or seven days.

**294** Out of curiosity Purī asked Him where He was born, and the Lord playfully answered, "A place called Navadvīpa."

**295** Śrī Raṅga Purī, the disciple of Śrī Mādhava Purī, had once come to the town of Nadīyā.

**296** He recalled the meal he had taken in the house of Jagannātha Miśra and the wonderful curry of banana flowers he had eaten there.

**297** “Jagannātha’s wife is a great and chaste lady; in her motherly love she is like the mother of the world.

**298** In all the three worlds no one equals her skill in cooking, and when she feeds sannyāsīs she loves them as her own sons.

**299** One worthy son of hers took *sannyāsa*. His name was Śaṅkarāraṇya, and he was young.

**300** At this holy place Śaṅkarāraṇya attained perfection (*siddhi*).” This is what Śrī Raṅga Purī told Him in the course of their talk.

**301** The Lord said, “In My former *āśrama* he was My brother, and Jagannātha Miśra was My father.”

**302** When the two had thus talked together of their Beloved (*iṣṭa-goṣṭhī*), Śrī Raṅga Purī set out to see Dvārakā.

**303** The brāhmaṇa kept the Lord there for four days. He bathed in the river Bhīmā and had *darśana* of Viṭhṭhala.

**304** Then Mahāprabhu came to the bank of the Kṛṣṇaveṇvā, and there He saw many holy places and temples of the gods.

**305** The whole society of brāhmaṇas there was Vaiṣṇava in character, and all those Vaiṣṇavas read the *Kṛṣṇa-karṇāmṛta*.

**306** Hearing the *Kṛṣṇa-karṇāmṛta*, the Lord was overjoyed, and He eagerly had the manuscript copied and took it with Him.

**307** Nothing in the three worlds equals the *Karṇāmṛta*, for from it comes the knowledge of pure love for Kṛṣṇa.

**308** Only one who constantly reads the *Karṇāmṛta* knows the furthest limit of Kṛṣṇa's beauty, sweetness and pastimes.

**309** Having obtained the two manuscripts, the *Brahma-saṁhitā* and the *Karṇāmṛta*, He brought them back with great care.

**310** After bathing in the Tāpī He came to Māhiṣmatīpura, and there He saw many holy places on the bank of the Narmadā.

**311** He saw Dhanus-tīrtha and bathed in the Nirvindhyā; then He came to the Ṛṣyamūka hill and the Daṇḍakāraṇya forest.

**312** In the forest He saw the "seven palm trees" — very old, very thick and very tall.

**313** Seeing the seven palms, the Lord embraced them, and the seven palms vanished, bodies and all.

**314** Seeing the empty place, the people were amazed and said, "This sannyāsī is an incarnation of Rāma.

**315** The palms have gone in their very bodies to the abode of Śrī Vaikuṇṭha. Who but Rāma alone has such power?"

**316** The Lord came and bathed in Lake Pampā; then He came to Pañcavaṭī and rested there.

**317** In Nāsika He saw Tryambaka and went on to Brahmagiri; then He came to Kuśāvarta, where the Godāvarī has its source.

**318** Visiting a great many holy places, He came to Sapta-godāvarī, and from there the Lord came once again to Vidyānagara.

**319** Hearing of the Lord's arrival, Rāmānanda Rāya came joyfully and met Him.

**320** He fell flat like a rod, clasping the Lord's feet, and the Lord raised him and embraced him.

**321** The two of them wept in ecstatic love, and in the bliss of love their hearts were overpowered.

**322** After a while the two grew calm, and sitting together, they talked at length of their Beloved.

**323** The Lord told him the whole story of His pilgrimage and gave him the two manuscripts, the *Karṇāmṛta* and the *Brahma-saṁhitā*.

**324** The Lord said, "These two books bear witness to that very *rasa* — the conclusions about love (*prema-siddhānta*) that you spoke to Me."

**325** Rāya was overjoyed to receive the books. He relished them together with the Lord and had copies made to keep.

**326** "The Gosāñi has come!" — a clamour rose in the village, and all the people came to see the Lord.

**327** Seeing the crowd, Rāmānanda went home, and at midday the Lord rose to take His meal.

**328** At night Rāya came again, and the two stayed awake all night talking about Kṛṣṇa.

**329** Night and day the two spoke about Kṛṣṇa, and five or seven days passed in supreme bliss.

**330** Rāmānanda said, “O Lord, with Your permission I have written humbly to the king.

**331** The king has ordered me to go to Nīlācala, and I have begun to prepare for the journey.”

**332** The Lord said, “It is for this very reason that I have come here: I shall take you with Me to Nīlācala.”

**333** Rāya said, “O Lord, please go ahead to Nīlācala; with me there are elephants and horses and the clamour of soldiers.

**334** In ten days or so I shall settle all this, and then I shall follow close behind You.”

**335** Then Mahāprabhu told him to come later, and the Lord set out joyfully for Nīlācala.

**336** The Lord went back by the same road by which He had come, seeing all the Vaiṣṇavas along the way.

**337** Wherever He went, the people rose up crying out “Hari!”, and seeing this, Gaurahari rejoiced at heart.

**338** Coming to Ālālanātha, He sent Kṛṣṇadāsa ahead to call Nityānanda and His other associates.

**339** Hearing of the Lord’s arrival, Nityānanda Rāya rose and set out at once, unable to contain Himself for love.

**340** Jagadānanda, Dāmodara Paṇḍita and Mukunda went along dancing; their bodies could not contain their joy.

**341** Gopīnātha Ācārya went joyfully too, and they all met the Lord when they came upon Him on the road.

**342** In ecstatic love the Lord embraced them all, and in ecstatic love they all wept for joy.

**343** Sārvabhauma Bhaṭṭācārya also went joyfully, and coming to the shore of the ocean, he met the Lord.

**344** Sārvabhauma fell at Mahāprabhu's feet, and the Lord raised him and embraced him.

**345** Sārvabhauma wept in ecstatic love, and the Lord went with them all to see the Lord, Jagannātha.

**346** In ecstatic love He had *darśana* of Jagannātha, and His body was flooded with trembling, sweat, horripilation and tears.

**347** Absorbed in love, He danced and sang at length, and all the temple servants, the *pāṇḍās* and *pālas*, came bringing garlands and *prasāda*.

**348** Receiving the garlands and *prasāda*, the Lord grew calm, and all the servants of Jagannātha met Him joyfully.

**349** Kāśī Miśra came and fell at the Lord's feet, and the Lord honoured him with an embrace.

**350** Sārvabhauma took the Lord to his own house, inviting Him with the words, "Your meal will be at my house."

**351** He had a great deal of excellent *mahā-prasāda* brought — cakes, sweet drinks and all that Jagannātha had eaten.

**352** The Lord performed His midday duties with His associates, then came to Sārvabhauma's house and took His meal.

**353** After serving Him the meal, he had Him lie down to rest, and Sārvabhauma himself massaged His feet.

**354** The Lord sent him off to take his own meal, and to please him He stayed that night in his house.

**355** With Sārvabhauma and His own associates He stayed awake all night, telling the story of His pilgrimage.

**356** The Lord said, "I have travelled to so many holy places, yet I have not seen a single Vaiṣṇava equal to you.

**357** Rāmānanda Rāya alone gave Me great happiness." The Bhaṭṭācārya said, "That is why I asked You to meet him."

**358** Thus I conclude the story of the pilgrimage. I have told it in brief; it cannot be described in full.

**359** I do not know how to describe Caitanya's endless pastimes; out of greed I have swallowed my shame and tugged at them.

**360** Whoever hears the story of the Lord's pilgrimage obtains the treasure of deep love at Caitanya's feet.

**361** Hear the deeds of Caitanya with faith and devotion; give up envy and say with your lips, "Hari! Hari!"

**362** In this age of Kali there is no other *dharma*: this is the heart of the matter, as the Vaiṣṇavas and the Vaiṣṇava scriptures declare.

**363** The pastimes of Caitanya-candra are fathomless and deep. I cannot enter them; I only touch them, standing on the shore.

**364** Whoever hears the deeds of Caitanya with faith obtains the treasure of love in the measure that he reflects on them.

**365** Praying at the feet of Śrī Rūpa and Śrī Raghunātha, I, Kṛṣṇadāsa, narrate the *Caitanya-caritāmṛta*.